

Writing a formal letter (III)

DISCUSS THE TOPIC

- What procedures does one go through when applying for a job?
- What do you think should be included in a letter of application?

SAMPLE WRITING

Read the rubric and the sample letter below. The letter includes information that is not appropriate for a letter of this type. Find it and cross it out.

You have seen this advertisement and have decided to apply for the job. Write your letter of application (120-180 words). Do not write any addresses.

Junior Office Assistant Required

Do you
want to
make
some
money
during the summer?

Oakwood & Danbury are looking for a junior office assistant

Applicants must be:

- under 21
- computer literate
- fluent in English
- organised and responsible

Apply in writing to:
P.O. Box 9923 DONCASTER, DN1 4QS

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to apply for the position of Junior Office Assistant as advertised in "The Daily" on 3rd May.

I am a seventeen-year-old student in my final year of High School. I am computer literate and currently attending a course in Computer Technology. I also have a computer at home on which I play computer games.

In addition, my knowledge of the English language is quite satisfactory. I am planning to sit the Higher Degree of English Examination in a few weeks, despite the fact that I failed it last year.

As you can see from my curriculum vitae, I have had previous experience as an office assistant. My duties included filing, answering the telephone and some typing, all of which helped me improve my organisational skills. I really enjoyed the job so that is why I would like a similar position this year. I am also interested in making some money for the summer holidays. I have enclosed a reference letter from my previous employer for your consideration.

If you feel that my qualifications meet your requirements, please note that I am available for an interview at your convenience. I look forward to a favourable reply.

Yours faithfully,

Jane Brown

Jane Brown

1 Answer these questions.

- a. Is the person suitable for the job? Why/Why not? *AWW*
- b. What is a curriculum vitae (CV) and a reference?

2 Suppose the advertisement had the following extra point: Applicants must be available in July. **What would you include in the letter in order to cover this point? In the space below write your answer in an appropriate style. In which part of the letter would you add it?**

PLAN

This unit deals with letters of application. What you include in the letter and how you organise it will depend on the rubric. Below is a general plan of a letter of application, with questions to help you when planning one. Read the plan and compare it to the sample.

Greeting

- use a formal greeting

Opening paragraph

use set phrases to state:

- which position you are applying for
- where/when you saw the advertisement

Why are you writing this letter?

What job are you applying for?

Where / When did you see the advertisement?

Main part
(2-3 paragraphs)

- mention your age
- describe your qualifications and experience
- state your present/previous job, if relevant
- state any interests/hobbies which are relevant
- explain why you believe you are suitable for the job

How old are you?

What have you studied?

Can you speak any foreign languages?

What sort of work experience have you had?

What do/did you do in your present/previous job?

What are some of your interests that are relevant to the job?

What else do you think makes you a suitable applicant?

Closing paragraph

use set phrases to state that:

- you hope your application will be taken into consideration
- you enclose a CV/reference

Are you enclosing a CV or a reference?

Is there anything you want to emphasise?

When would you be available for an interview?

When would you be available to start?

Signing off

- Use a formal signature ending. Sign underneath this and print your full name below your signature.

GUIDE TO WRITING

- Use formal language.
- Invent a name for a newspaper/magazine and a date when referring to the advertisement in your letter if these are not mentioned in the rubric.
- Identify the qualities required for the position and expand on them.
- Write in a confident manner, describing your good qualities. Don't mention any bad qualities/failures or irrelevant details. Don't mention that you want the job for the money.
- State that you are enclosing a CV and/or reference.

- Use set phrases and expressions in your letter. Look at the following table for ideas.

Set phrases for opening paragraph	- I am writing with regard to/in connection with your advertisement in (where). - I am writing to apply for the position of (job) as advertised in (where) on the (date). - I am interested in applying for the job of...
Expressions for describing your qualifications and experience	- I have studied/been working for... - I am presently/currently employed at/attending... - My qualifications include... - My knowledge of... - I have a degree/certificate in... - I am familiar with/experienced in/fluent in... - I have previous experience as/working at... - As you can see from my curriculum vitae,... - I believe I am suitable for the position of... - I consider myself well qualified for the position of... - I am a highly motivated person...
Set phrases for closing paragraph	- If you feel that my qualifications meet your requirements, please note that I am available for an interview at your convenience. (could also be included in the main part) - I enclose/have attached a copy of my curriculum vitae outlining my qualifications and experience. - I look forward to hearing from you/a favourable reply. - I hope my application will be taken into consideration.

WRITING PRACTICE

- Read the rubric below. Circle the four points in the advertisement which you must expand on when writing a letter of application. Then, make notes of how you are going to justify each of these points, in the space provided.

*You have seen this advertisement and have decided to apply for the job.
Write your letter of application (120-180 words). Do not write any addresses.*

**ARE YOU LOOKING FOR A FUN
PART-TIME JOB?**

GALIANO'S CAFÉ

is looking for waiters / waitresses.

- You must be able to work at weekends.
- Experience operating a coffee machine is preferred.
- We offer basic training and excellent working conditions.

If you are friendly and energetic, then write to us explaining why you think you would be suitable for this job.

- b. Complete the opening paragraph and the main part of the letter of application using the notes you have made.

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing in connection with your advertisement which _____

I am _____

Furthermore, I would like to mention that _____

I consider myself _____

- c. Now write a suitable closing paragraph and sign off the letter.

- 2 Read the following sentences. Indicate whether or not they could have been included in the above letter by putting a tick (✓) or a cross (X) in the boxes provided. Give reasons for your answers.

- a. I have a very polite and pleasant personality. ☐ _____
- b. Anyway, you can see all my qualifications in my CV. ☐ _____
- c. I sometimes have to do the shopping on Saturday mornings, however that is something that can be arranged. ☐ _____
- d. I am able to work three afternoons during the week. ☐ _____

- e. I have a moped licence, which I believe is an advantage. ☐ _____
- f. I am not able to enclose a reference as it is very difficult for me to get one. ☐ _____
- g. I guess I can come for an interview if you like. ☐ _____
- h. My hobbies include reading and stamp collecting. ☐ _____
- i. I have good communication skills. ☐ _____
- j. I believe I am suitable for the job as I have been to your café many times with my friends. ☒ _____

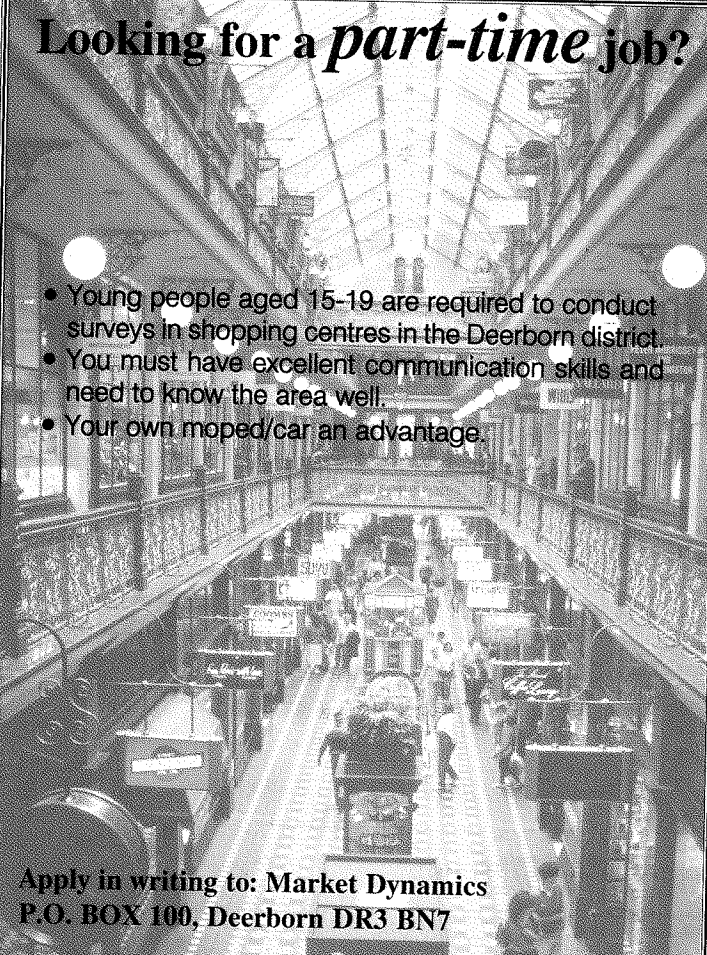
3 Read the rubric below. Write a plan for the letter in the space provided.

You have just read this advertisement in a local newspaper and have decided to apply for the job. Write a letter of application (120-180 words). Do not write any addresses.

Looking for a *part-time* job?

- Young people aged 15-19 are required to conduct surveys in shopping centres in the Deerbourn district.
- You must have excellent communication skills and need to know the area well.
- Your own moped/car an advantage.

**Apply in writing to: Market Dynamics
P.O. BOX 100, Deerbourn DR3 BN7**



4 Task for homework.

Write the letter of application using the plan you made in exercise 3.